



This guide takes you through every feature of NG-CDF FAPM, the Field Activity Planning and Monitoring System built for the Office of the CEO, on your own machine. Follow it in order: set up once, run the main walkthrough, then test the rules, views, reports and security controls. Each step says what to do and what you should see.

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Local testing only. The accounts below use the password **password** and exist only on a developer machine. The seeder that creates them refuses to run when APP_ENV is staging or production. Real accounts are created with **php artisan activities:create-user**. The live system is RESTRICTED to the CEO, the Chief of Staff and the Assistant Chief of Staff.

1. Start the application

- 1 **Open a terminal in the project:** `activities.ngcdf.go.ke`.
- 2 **Make sure the database is up to date:** run **php artisan migrate** and then **php artisan db:seed**. This sets up everything the app needs: the three roles, the 10 regions, 47 counties and 290 constituencies, departments, designations, duty stations, activity types, cost types, county DSA categories, thresholds, provisional DSA rates and, on a local machine, the three test accounts. Seeding is safe to repeat: the editable lists are seeded once, and a second run never undoes a change made in Settings.
- 3 **Start the app:** run **composer run dev** and open **http://localhost:8000**. You land on the sign-in page.
- 4 **Reset the accounts at any time:** **php artisan db:seed UserSeeder** puts the passwords back to password, unlocks the accounts and removes any two-factor set-up.

Test accounts

Role	Email	Password	Use it to test
Chief Executive Officer	ceo@ngcdf.go.ke	password	Decisions, directives, dashboard, reports
Chief of Staff	cos@ngcdf.go.ke	password	Set-up, capturing activities, recording decisions, closing, user accounts
Assistant Chief of Staff	acos@ngcdf.go.ke	password	Capturing and execution with a narrower set of permissions

Use a separate browser, or a private window, for each role. Signing an account in ends that account's other sessions, and two different users cannot share one browser session.

Who can do what (FRD section 4.1)

Action	CEO	Chief of Staff	Assistant
View dashboards, calendar, register and reports	Yes	Yes	Yes
Create and edit activities, participants and costs	Yes	Yes	Yes
Submit an activity for the CEO's decision	No	Yes	Yes
Approve, decline or return	Yes	No	No
Record a decision the CEO gave outside the system	Yes	Yes	No
Issue directives	Yes	Yes	No
Postpone	Yes	Yes	Yes
Cancel, close	Yes	Yes	No
Commencement, attendance, reports, actual costs	Yes	Yes	Yes
Reference data, staff list, DSA rates, budgets, thresholds	No	Yes	No

Export and print	Yes	Yes	No
Manage the three user accounts	No	Yes	No
Audit trail and access log	Yes	Yes	No

2. One-time set-up, as the Chief of Staff

Sign in as cos@ngcdf.go.ke. Everything here is under Office of the CEO in the sidebar.

- Import the staff list:** open **Staff list**, click **Import HR list** and upload **docs/samples/hr-staff-list.csv**. Expect "16 added, 0 updated". Fifteen officers are active; Tom Were is inactive and does not appear when choosing participants. Import the same file again and expect "0 added, 16 updated": officers are matched by PF number and nothing is duplicated.
- Try a bad import:** edit a copy of the file, blank one Name and upload it. Nothing is imported and the row with the problem is listed.
- Check the DSA rates:** open **Reference data**, tab **DSA rates**. A fresh installation has provisional placeholder rates, the table below, marked Provisional with a warning banner. Add a real rate for a grade and destination and it replaces the provisional one from its effective date. Without any rate, DSA cannot be calculated.
- Check destination categories:** tab **DSA destinations**. Nairobi City, Mombasa, Kisumu, Nakuru and Uasin Gishu are set to Cities; every other county is Other towns. These are provisional until the CEO confirms OI-01.
- Look at the thresholds:** tab **Thresholds**. Defaults: late notice 7 working days, report due 5 working days, 30 field days a quarter and 100 a year, date change tolerance 2 days, extension tolerance 1 day, team change tolerance 1 person, cost increase tolerance 10 per cent, DSA per night.
- Optional, add a budget line:** tab **Budget lines**, for example Projects, Planning and M&E, FY 2026/27, KES 500,000. Department costs will then show the allocation and what remains.

Provisional DSA rates seeded at installation (not official figures)

Job grade	Cities (KES per night)	Other towns (KES per night)
NGCDF 1	18,000	15,000
NGCDF 2	16,000	13,500
NGCDF 3	14,000	12,000
NGCDF 4	12,600	10,500
NGCDF 5	10,500	8,400
NGCDF 6	8,400	7,000
NGCDF 7	7,000	5,600
NGCDF 8	7,000	5,600

Adding a second rate for the same grade and destination with a later date ends the earlier one the day before. The old rate stays, and activities that started under it keep it.

3. Main walkthrough: one activity from memo to closure

About 20 minutes. It touches every status: Draft, Awaiting decision, Approved, In progress, Completed, Report received, Closed.

- Record the activity (Chief of Staff):** **Activity register**, then **Record activity**. Title "Proposal review, Kakamega", category Monitoring & Evaluation, type Proposal review, an objective, requesting department Projects, Planning & M&E, memo number, today as the start date, 3 days, county Kakamega, and any PDF as the source document. As you change the days, the end date and number of nights update on screen. Save. Expect a Draft with a reference such as FAPM-2026-27-00001, marked Late notice because it starts within 7 working days. Starting today lets you run the whole walkthrough now.
- Add the team:** tab **Team**, then **Add officers**. Tick Peter Otieno (NGCDF 5), Amina Hassan (NGCDF 6) and Joseph Mutua (NGCDF 8). Each row shows field days for the quarter and the year against the limits.
- Check the DSA:** tab **Costs**. Three DSA lines appear, one per officer: 2 nights at the Other towns rate. Peter: $2 \times 8,400 = 16,800$. Amina: $2 \times 7,000 = 14,000$. Joseph: $2 \times 5,600 = 11,200$. Planned total 42,000.
- Add other costs:** **Add cost**, Board vehicle fuel, Whole activity (shared), 18,500. Then Travel for Peter with travel mode Air, 12,000. Planned total becomes 72,500. The Team tab now shows each person's direct cost plus an equal share of the fuel.

- 5 **Override a DSA line:** on Amina's DSA line click the pencil, enter 10,500 and a justification. The line shows "Overridden from 14,000.00" with your reason. Click **Recalculate DSA**: the override stays.
- 6 **Submit:** click **Submit to CEO**. Status becomes Awaiting decision. To see the rules, try submitting another draft that has no source document, no location or no staff: each is refused with the reason.
- 7 **Decide (CEO):** in the CEO browser the bell shows a new alert and the sidebar shows a count on Decision queue. Open **Decision queue**. The card shows dates, place, team, planned cost, cost per head and any conflicts. Click **Return** without a comment: it is refused, a comment is required. Click **Approve**. Status becomes Approved and the Chief of Staff gets an alert.
- 8 **Confirm commencement (Chief of Staff or Assistant):** the button appears from the start date, so it is there now. Click **Confirm commencement**. Status becomes In progress. On a future activity the button is hidden until its start date; after that, an unconfirmed start shows amber, then red after two days.
- 9 **Record attendance:** tab Team. Set Peter and Joseph to Attended and Amina to Did not attend. Change Peter's days if needed. Only attended officers count toward actual days and actual cost.
- 10 **Mark completed: Mark completed**, optionally with an actual end date. Status becomes Completed and the report due date is set 5 working days after the end date. The daily job does this automatically for in-progress activities whose end date has passed.
- 11 **Record the report: Record report**, with date received, outputs achieved, findings and recommendations. The Report tab shows expected against achieved outputs. Status becomes Report received.
- 12 **Enter actuals and close:** tab Costs. Type an actual amount and a finance reference on every line; each saves when you leave the field. Try **Close** before all lines have actuals: it is refused. Enter 0 where nothing was spent, then close. Status becomes Closed and the activity is read only.
- 13 **Check the history:** tab History shows every status change with who and when. Amendments are listed beside it.

4. Decisions and returns

- 1 **Decision given outside the system:** as the Chief of Staff, on a Draft or Awaiting decision activity, click **Record CEO decision**. Memo reference, memo date and a scanned copy are all required. The decision is labelled "Recorded on the CEO's behalf" and the scan appears on the Decisions tab. The Assistant does not see this button.
- 2 **Return with a directive:** as the CEO, return an activity with a comment. The Chief of Staff sees an orange banner with the CEO's comment, can edit the activity and submit it again.
- 3 **Decline:** declined activities are final and read only.
- 4 **Retrospective:** record a decision whose memo date is after the activity's start date. The activity is flagged Retrospective on the register and dashboard. Capturing an activity after it started does not, on its own, make it retrospective.
- 5 **Late notice:** record an activity starting within 7 working days of today. It carries a Late notice badge in the queue, the register and the dashboard.

5. Changes after approval

After submission, changes to dates, team and planned cost are recorded as amendments with a reason. A change beyond tolerance sends the activity back to the CEO.

- 1 **Small postponement:** on an approved activity, **Postpone** by 1 day with a reason. It stays Approved and the amendment appears in History.
- 2 **Large postponement:** postpone by 10 days. It goes back to Awaiting decision and the CEO gets an "Amended, back for decision" alert.
- 3 **Postpone without dates:** leave the new date blank. Status becomes Postponed; use **Reschedule** later.
- 4 **Extension:** **Extend** by 1 day stays approved; by 3 days returns to the CEO. DSA is recalculated for the extra nights.
- 5 **Team change:** adding or removing officers on an approved activity asks for a reason. It returns to the CEO if more than one person changes at once, or if the new DSA lifts the planned cost more than 10 per cent above the approved total. Adding one low-cost officer to a large activity stays approved.
- 6 **Cost increase:** raise the planned cost by more than 10 per cent of the approved total. It returns to the CEO.
- 7 **Cancel:** **Cancel** needs a reason. Costs already incurred stay recorded. Drafts are instead **Discarded**. Nothing is ever permanently deleted.

6. Participant checks

- 1 **Different days per participant:** an activity's dates are its whole span; people need not attend every day. On the Team tab click the calendar icon beside a person's days, enter their first day and number of days, and save. The last day and nights are worked out as you type, and you are told if the days would run past the activity's end. Their days, DSA nights, field-day totals, overlap checks and "In the field today" all follow their own dates. For example, on a 35-day activity set one officer to start on day 5 for 5 days: they show 5 days, their DSA drops to 4 nights, and the activity itself stays 35 days. After submission the change needs a reason and is recorded as an amendment. Postponing the activity moves everyone's dates with it.
- 2 **Overlap conflict:** approve one activity with Peter Otieno. Create a second activity on overlapping dates and try to add Peter. You must give a reason to proceed. The reason is shown on the Team tab and in the decision queue.
- 3 **Field-day limit:** in Thresholds set the quarter limit to 4. Open any team with 3 or more days: officers over the limit show in red with a flag, and the queue warns the CEO.
- 4 **External participants:** Add external, for example an MP. Cost per head is shown both for staff only and including externals. Untick "Count external participants in cost per head" in Edit to exclude them from the per-head share.

7. Views and analysis

Screen	What to check
Dashboard	Figures for the chosen year and quarter: awaiting decision, in the field today, overdue reports, delivery rate, planned and actual cost, late notice, retrospective. Every figure opens the list behind it. Show and hide figures is remembered.
Decision queue	Everything awaiting the CEO, soonest first, with conflicts and field-day warnings.
Activity register	Search by title, reference, memo or officer. Filter by status, department, year, and under More filters by officer, type, region, county, quarter, date range and flag. Sort by any column. "Showing x of y" updates. Cards replace the table on a phone.
Calendar	Month and week views with filters. Activities by different departments in the same county on overlapping dates are marked as possible joint missions.
In the field today	Every officer on an activity today, with location and return date.
Directives	Directives issued from an activity or on their own, with department and due date. Mark complete with a note. Overdue ones are counted in the sidebar.
Staff participation	One row per officer with activities, planned and actual days, did not attend, field days against the limit, DSA and travel. Expand a row for the activities. The list of active staff with no participation is at the bottom.
Department costs	Board-wide DSA, travel and grand total, and a table per department. Switch between requesting department (with budget and remaining) and officer's department.

8. Reports and exports

- 1 **Open Reports:** ten standard reports: Field Activity Plan, Weekly Field Schedule, Decisions Register, Planned against Actual, Officer Field Days, Department Field Expenditure, Overdue Reports and Directives, Coverage, Activity Register, Access and Audit Log.
- 2 **Export:** as the CEO or Chief of Staff use Excel, PDF or Print. Each export carries the RESTRICTED marking and "Produced by" your name and the time, at top and bottom.
- 3 **Filtered export:** filter the register, then export. The file holds only the rows on screen.
- 4 **Assistant:** the export buttons are hidden, and typing the export address directly is refused.

9. Security controls

Control	How to test	Expected
Lockout	Enter a wrong password 5 times	Account locked for 30 minutes. With the right password the page says it is locked and when it unlocks. The Chief of Staff can unlock it under User accounts.
Account messages	Deactivate the Assistant, then sign in as them with the wrong and then the right password	Wrong password: the usual "credentials do not match". Right password: "This account has been deactivated". The page never reveals which emails exist.

One active account per role	User accounts, try to create a second CEO	Refused until the current CEO account is deactivated.
One session per user	Sign in as the same user in two browsers	The first browser is signed out on its next click.
Idle timeout	Leave a signed-in page for 15 minutes	The next click returns you to sign in.
Two-factor (optional)	Open Profile and turn on two-factor authentication with an authenticator app, then sign out and in	Sign-in now asks for the 6-digit code on the Security check page. It is not required: an account without it signs straight in. Setting <code>ACTIVITIES_REQUIRE_TWO_FACTOR=true</code> in <code>.env</code> makes it compulsory for everyone.
Access log	Open an activity, export a report, download a document	Each appears in Audit and access log, with the user, time and IP address.
Change audit	Edit anything	The audit log shows who changed what and the new values. The old values are kept in the database for investigation.
Attachments	Look in <code>storage/app/private/activities</code>	Files end in <code>.enc</code> and cannot be opened directly. They download normally from the app.
Outsiders	Visit <code>/register</code> , or a page while signed out	Registration does not exist; every page requires sign-in.

10. Submission links

Links let a memo originator send an activity in without an account. They conflict with FRD section 2.2, so they are switched off by default and are on only in your local `.env` (`ACTIVITIES_SUBMISSION_LINKS=true`) until the CEO decides.

- 1 **Create a link:** as the Chief of Staff, **Submission links**, then **New link** with a label, recipient, expiry and a maximum of 1 submission. Copy the link.
- 2 **Submit through it:** open the link in a private window. Fill in the activity, upload any PDF as the memo and upload **docs/samples/participant-list.csv**. Expect "4 participants read". Submit and note the reference.
- 3 **Review it:** the Chief of Staff gets an alert. The activity is a Draft marked Received via link, with the team, the MP and both files attached. Review it, then submit it to the CEO in the normal way.
- 4 **Link rules:** open the link again. It now says it is not available, because the maximum was 1. **New link** kills the old address; **Revoke** stops it at once.

11. Scheduled jobs and automated tests

- 1 **Daily job: php artisan activities:daily** completes in-progress activities past their end date, and raises commencement and overdue-report alerts.
- 2 **Monday summary: php artisan activities:weekly-summary** posts the CEO's weekly summary in the bell.
- 3 **Automated tests: php artisan test** runs the full suite on an in-memory database. Your data is never touched. Expect all tests to pass, with 10 skipped for Jetstream features that are switched off.

12. Not built yet

Bulk import of departmental plans (PL-05), planned for phase 3.

Pending

Import of the old tracker's records as closed history (CF-13), planned for phase 3.

Pending

Leave clashes (PT-05) need leave data from HR.

Pending

Budget warning at approval (CB-05). Department costs already show budget and remaining.

Pending

Server security: database and backup encryption, HTTPS and network restriction are set up on the server. See the README checklist.

Deployment

13. When something looks wrong

DSA is not calculated: check that the officer has a job grade, that the activity has a county, and that a rate exists for that grade and the county's destination category.

A button is missing: check the role table in section 1 and the activity's status. Buttons appear only when the action is allowed.

Cannot sign in: run `php artisan db:seed UserSeeder` to reset the three accounts.

Starting again from nothing: `php artisan migrate:fresh` followed by `php artisan db:seed` deletes every activity, staff record and setting on your machine and rebuilds the starting configuration. Only do this on a local test database, never on staging or production.

Report a problem: note the activity reference, the account used and what you expected. The history and audit log show what happened.